

Word family: **wide / wider / widest / widely / widen / width / widespread**

Base word: wide

Comparative: wider

Superlative: widest

Adverb: widely

Related forms: widen, width, widespread

Useful constructions/extensions: widely respected, wide road, wide range, wide variety, wide difference, wide gap, wide open, open wide, far and wide, wide of the mark, widespread, worldwide distinction, widen the gap, width

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / adverb-related form (副詞相關形式) / verb and noun family members (相關動詞及名詞)

Your passage contains:

> “She is **widely respected** in my family and even in the neighbourhood.”

Here, **widely** means:

by many people and across a broad social group.

Meaning in this passage

In:

> **widely respected**

widely does not describe physical width.

It means:

to a great extent among many people / in many parts of a group or community.

Your grandmother is respected not just by:

- * one person;
- * one close relative;
- * one household member.

Instead, the respect extends across:

- * your family;
- * people in the neighbourhood.

****Meaning:**** By many people or across a broad group, area, or range.

****繁體中文：**** ****廣泛地；受到很多人 / 不同群體普遍地.....；這裡指她在家人和鄰里之間普遍受到尊重****

****中文翻譯：****

> “She is widely respected in my family and even in the neighbourhood.”

「她在我家裡，甚至在鄰里之間，都****廣受尊重****。」

So:

****widely respected = 廣受尊重 / 受到很多人普遍尊重****

This is the exact passage meaning.

1. ****wide = large distance from side to side (寬的) — 寬；寬闊****

This is the basic literal meaning.

****Meaning:**** Measuring a large distance from one side to the other.

Practice 1

> “The road is very ****wide****.”

「這條路很****寬****。」

Practice 2

> “They sat at a ****wide table****.”

「他們坐在一張很****寬的桌子****旁。」

****wide = 從一邊到另一邊的橫向距離較大****

2. ****wide road/door/river (寬闊的道路 / 門 / 河) — 寬的；寬闊的****

Practice 3

> “The entrance is wide enough for two people.”

「入口**夠寬**，可以讓兩個人同時通過。」

Practice 4

> “They crossed a **wide river**.”

「他們跨過了一條**寬闊的河流**。」

****wide = 某個物體 / 空間橫向延伸的距離大****

3. ****wide = broad opening (張得很開的) — 張開很大的 ; 大開的****

A major physical extension.

Practice 5

> “She opened her eyes **wide**.”

「她把眼睛**睜得很大**。」

Practice 6

> “The door was **wide open**.”

「門**大開著**。」

****wide = 開口、眼睛、門等張開到很大的程度****

4. ****open wide (張大 / 大開) — 張大 ; 完全打開****

A very common construction.

Practice 7

> “Open your mouth **wide**.”

「把嘴巴**張大**。」

Practice 8

> “He opened the window **wide**.”

「他把窗戶**完全打開**。」

****open wide = 令開口張開到很大的程度****

5. ****wide open (完全打開的) — 大開 ; 完全敞開****

Practice 9

> “The window was ****wide open****.”

「窗戶**完全敞開**。」

Practice 10

> “She left the door wide open.”

「她讓門**大開著**。」

****wide open = 開口完全或非常大程度地打開****

6. ****wide = covering a large area/range (廣泛的) — 廣泛的 ; 範圍大的****

A major figurative sense.

Practice 11

> “The course covers a ****wide range**** of topics.”

「這個課程涵蓋**廣泛的主題**。」

Practice 12

> “She has a ****wide knowledge**** of the subject.”

「她對這個題目有**廣泛的知識**。」

****wide = 涵蓋的範圍、種類或領域很大****

7. ****wide range (廣泛範圍) — 很多種類 ; 很大範圍****

A major collocation.

Practice 13

> “The shop offers a **wide range of** teas.”

「這間店提供**很多不同種類的茶**。」

Practice 14

> “The issue affects a **wide range of** people.”

「這個問題影響**很多不同類型的人**。」

a wide range of = 涵蓋很多不同種類、程度或選項

8. **wide variety** (種類很多) — 多種多樣；種類廣泛

Practice 15

> “The market sells a **wide variety of** fruit.”

「市場出售**多種不同水果**。」

Practice 16

> “People gave a **wide variety of** answers.”

「人們給出了**各式各樣的答案**。」

wide variety = 種類很多、差異範圍很大的集合

9. **wide choice/selection** (選擇很多) — 選擇範圍廣

Practice 17

> “Customers have a **wide choice of** products.”

「顧客有**很多選擇**。」

Practice 18

> “The website offers a wide selection of courses.”

「網站提供**廣泛的課程選擇**。」

wide choice/selection = 可供選擇的項目數量 / 種類很多

10. **wide = large difference/gap (差距大的) — 差距大；相差很遠**

A major abstract sense.

Practice 19

> “There is a **wide gap** between the two results.”

「兩個結果之間有**很大的差距**。」

Practice 20

> “Their opinions are **widely different**.”

「他們的意見**相差很大**。」

wide = 兩個數值、觀點、狀態等之間的距離 / 差異很大

11. **wide gap (巨大差距) — 大差距；鴻溝**

Practice 21

> “There is a **wide gap** between theory and practice.”

「理論與實踐之間有**很大的差距**。」

Practice 22

> “The income gap remains wide.”

「收入**差距仍然很大**。」

wide gap = 兩個群體、數值、狀態或觀點之間有很大距離

12. **wide difference (明顯差異) — 很大的不同**

Practice 23

> “There is a **wide difference** in experience between them.”

「他們的經驗有**很大差異**。」

Practice 24

> “Prices vary widely between regions.”

「不同地區的價格**差異很大**。」

wide difference = 兩者之間的差異程度很大

13. **widely = by many people / in many places (廣泛地) — 廣泛地 ; 普遍地**

This is the exact family form used in your passage.

Practice 25 — Original

> “She is **widely respected** in my family and even in the neighbourhood.”

「她在家人甚至鄰里之間都**廣受尊重**。」

Practice 26

> “The book is **widely read**.”

「這本書**廣受閱讀 / 很多人都讀過**。」

Practice 27

> “The idea is **widely accepted**.”

「這個想法**被廣泛接受**。」

widely = 在很多人、地方、群體或情況中都有 / 都發生

14. **widely respected/known/accepted (廣受尊重 / 廣為人知 / 廣泛接受) — 普遍地**

Practice 28

> “She is **widely known** for her kindness.”

「她因善良而**廣為人知**。」

Practice 29

> “The method is widely accepted.”

「這個方法**廣泛獲得接受**。」

widely + participle/adjective = 某種看法、知名度或接受程度遍及很多人 / 地方

15. **widely used (廣泛使用) — 普遍使用**

Practice 30

> “This software is **widely used**.”

「這套軟件被**廣泛使用**。」

Practice 31

> “The expression is widely used in conversation.”

「這個表達在日常對話中**廣泛使用**。」

widely used = 在很多人、地方、領域或情況中使用

16. **widely available (廣泛可得) — 到處可取得；普遍供應**

Practice 32

> “The product is **widely available**.”

「這件產品**很容易在很多地方買到 / 廣泛供應**。」

Practice 33

> “Online courses are now widely available.”

「網上課程現在**普遍都可以找到**。」

****widely available = 在很多地方 / 渠道都能取得****

17. ****widely distributed (廣泛分布) — 分布廣泛****

Practice 34

> “The species is ****widely distributed****.”

「這個物種****分布廣泛****。」

Practice 35

> “The report was widely distributed.”

「這份報告被****廣泛派發 / 分發****。」

****widely distributed = 分布 / 傳播到很多地方或對象****

18. ****widely = greatly / by a large amount (相差很大地) — 大幅 ; 很大程度地****

A separate adverb sense.

Practice 36

> “Opinions ****vary widely****.”

「意見****差異很大****。」

Practice 37

> “Prices vary widely from one shop to another.”

「不同商店的價格****相差很大****。」

****widely = 程度 / 數值 / 看法之間有很大差距****

This is different from:

> widely respected

where it means:

> by many people.

19. **vary widely** (差異很大) — 變化很大；相差甚遠

Practice 38

> “The quality can **vary widely**.”

「品質可以**相差很大**。」

Practice 39

> “Opinions on the issue **vary widely**.”

「人們對這個問題的看法**差異非常大**。」

vary widely = 不同個案之間的數值、程度、品質等差距很大

20. **wide** = far from a target (偏得很遠) — 偏離；射偏

A genuinely separate sense.

Practice 40

> “The ball went **wide**.”

「球**射偏了 / 出了界外**。」

Practice 41

> “His shot was **wide** of the goal.”

「他的射門**偏離了球門**。」

wide = 沒有擊中目標，而是從側面偏離目標

Common especially in sports.

21. **wide of the mark (偏離目標 / 判斷錯誤) — 偏離 ; 不準確**

Literal and figurative.

Practice 42

> “The shot went **wide of the mark**.”

「射擊**偏離了目標**。」

Practice 43

> “His estimate was **wide of the mark**.”

「他的估計**差得很遠 / 很不準確**。」

wide of the mark = 沒有擊中目標 ; 比喻上指估計、判斷或說法相當不準確

22. **far and wide (到處 ; 四面八方) — 到處 ; 廣泛地**

A major idiom.

Practice 44

> “People came from **far and wide**.”

「人們從**四面八方 / 各地**而來。」

Practice 45

> “They searched far and wide for the missing file.”

「他們**到處**尋找遺失的檔案。」

far and wide = 在很多地方、很大的地域範圍內

23. **wide awake (完全清醒) — 非常清醒 ; 毫無睡意**

A major fixed expression.

Practice 46

> “I was **wide awake** before the presentation.”

「簡報前我**完全沒有睡意 / 非常清醒**。」

Practice 47

> “The noise kept me wide awake.”

「噪音令我**完全睡不著**。」

wide awake = 完全清醒，一點也沒有睡著 / 想睡

Here **wide** intensifies **awake**.

24. **wide-eyed** (睜大眼睛的 / 天真的) — 睜大眼；天真驚訝的

A useful compound.

Practice 48

> “The child stared at the stage **wide-eyed**.”

「孩子**睜大眼睛**看著舞台。」

Practice 49

> “She arrived as a wide-eyed young student.”

「她當時是一個**天真、對一切充滿驚奇的年輕學生**。」

wide-eyed = 眼睛睜得很大；比喻上亦可指天真、驚訝或充滿好奇

25. **widespread** (廣泛存在 / 傳播的) — 廣泛的；普遍的

A major related adjective.

Practice 50

> “The idea gained **widespread support**.”

「這個想法獲得**廣泛支持**。」

Practice 51

> “There was widespread concern about the problem.”

「人們對這個問題有**普遍的憂慮**。」

****widespread = 在很多地方、很多人或大範圍中存在 / 發生的****

26. ****widespread damage/problem/use (大範圍的) — 廣泛；普遍****

Practice 52

> “The storm caused ****widespread damage****.”

「暴風造成****大範圍破壞****。」

Practice 53

> “The practice became widespread.”

「這種做法變得****十分普遍****。」

****widespread = 影響 / 存在的地域、人群或情況範圍很大****

27. ****widen = become/make wider (變寬 / 拓寬) — 變寬；拓寬****

A major related verb.

Practice 54

> “The road ****widens**** after the bridge.”

「過了橋之後，道路會****變寬****。」

Practice 55

> “They plan to ****widen the entrance****.”

「他們計劃****拓寬入口****。」

****widen = 使橫向寬度增加，或本身變得更寬****

28. **widen = increase a gap/difference (擴大差距) — 擴大；加深**

A major figurative verb sense.

Practice 56

> “The gap between the two groups **widened**.”

「兩個群體之間的差距**擴大了**。」

Practice 57

> “The disagreement continued to widen.”

「雙方的分歧繼續**擴大**。」

widen = 令兩個數值、群體、觀點等之間的差距逐漸增加

29. **widen your knowledge/experience (擴闊知識 / 經驗) — 擴闊；拓展**

Practice 58

> “Travel can **widen your experience**.”

「旅行可以**擴闊你的經驗 / 眼界**。」

Practice 59

> “Reading widely can widen your knowledge.”

「廣泛閱讀可以**擴闊知識面**。」

widen = 令知識、經驗、選擇或視野的範圍增加

30. **width (寬度) — 寬度**

A major related noun.

Practice 60

> “Measure the **width** of the table.”

「量一下桌子的**寬度**。」

Practice 61

> “The road is five metres in width.”

「這條路的**寬度**是五米。」

width = 從一邊到另一邊的橫向距離

31. **width** = extent/range figuratively (幅度 / 範圍) — 寬度 ; 範圍

A more abstract extension.

Practice 62

> “The width of the gap increased.”

「差距的**幅度 / 寬度**增加了。」

Practice 63

> “The design allows adjustment of the column width.”

「這個設計可以調整欄位的**寬度**。」

width = 某個空間、欄位、範圍的橫向大小

32. **wide-ranging** (涵蓋廣泛的) — 範圍廣泛的

A very useful compound.

Practice 64

> “They had a **wide-ranging discussion**.”

「他們進行了一場**涵蓋範圍很廣的討論**。」

Practice 65

> “The report makes wide-ranging recommendations.”

「報告提出了**涉及很多領域的建議**。」

wide-ranging = 涵蓋很多不同主題、領域或問題的

33. **wide-reaching / far-reaching distinction (影響廣泛) — 影響範圍大**

Wide-reaching exists, but **far-reaching** is often more idiomatic when talking about consequences.

Practice 66

> “The decision had **far-reaching consequences**.”

「這個決定帶來了**影響深遠的後果**。」

Practice 67

> “The policy affects a wide range of people.”

「這項政策影響**很廣泛的人群**。」

For learners, prefer:

> **wide-ranging** for breadth of topics

and:

> **far-reaching** for broad/deep consequences.

34. **wide-screen / widescreen (寬螢幕) — 寬螢幕的**

A useful media/technology compound.

Practice 68

> “The film was designed for **widescreen**.”

「這部電影是為**寬螢幕格式**製作的。」

Practice 69

> “They bought a widescreen television.”

「他們買了一部**寬螢幕電視**。」

widescreen = 畫面寬高比例較寬的顯示 / 電影格式

35. **wide-angle (廣角的) — 廣角**

A major photography compound.

Practice 70

> “She used a **wide-angle lens**.”

「她使用了一支**廣角鏡頭**。」

Practice 71

> “A wide-angle shot shows more of the room.”

「**廣角畫面**可以顯示更多房間範圍。」

wide-angle = 能捕捉較廣視野範圍的攝影 / 鏡頭形式

36. **worldwide vs widespread vs widely (全球 / 廣泛 / 廣泛地) — 重要區別**

These forms are easily confused.

widely

= adverb: 廣泛地

> widely respected

widespread

= adjective: 在很多地方 / 人群普遍存在的

> widespread support

****worldwide****

= across the world / 全球的、全球地

> worldwide sales

They are related in shape but not interchangeable.

Important distinction: ****wide vs broad****

These overlap heavily.

****wide****

often emphasizes:

- * side-to-side distance;
- * range;
- * gap;
- * spread.

****broad****

can also mean physically wide, but is especially common for:

- * broad knowledge;
- * broad agreement;
- * broad category;
- * broad shoulders.

Compare:

> wide road

> broad road

both possible.

But some fixed collocations strongly prefer one form:

> wide range 

> broad range 

Both natural.

> broad shoulders 

more natural than:

> wide shoulders

in many contexts.

Important distinction: **wide** vs **big**

wide

describes:

> side-to-side dimension or breadth/range.

big

describes:

> overall size, importance, amount, or scale.

Compare:

> “a wide table”

= table has large width.

> “a big table”

= table is large overall.

Not identical.

Important distinction: **wide** vs **long**

wide

= side-to-side dimension.

****long****

= end-to-end dimension.

A room can be:

> 10 metres long

and:

> 6 metres wide.

Different axes.

Important distinction: ****wide vs high****

****wide****

= horizontal breadth.

****high****

= vertical height/level.

> wide window

= width large.

> high window

= positioned high or tall depending context.

Important distinction: ****wide vs thick****

****wide****

= distance from one side to another.

****thick****

= distance between opposite surfaces / depth of material.

> a wide book

unusual if referring to spine thickness.

> a thick book

= many pages / thick volume.

Important distinction: **widely vs wide**

Adjective:

> “a **wide** range”

Adverb:

> “The method is **widely** used.”

Do not normally say:

>  a widely range

or:

>  it is wide used

Important distinction: **widely respected vs highly respected**

Both are natural but different.

widely respected

= respected by **many people / across a broad group**.

highly respected

= respected to a **very high degree**.

A person could theoretically be:

> highly respected by a small specialist group

but not:

> widely respected.

Your passage emphasizes **breadth of people**, not merely strength of respect.

Important distinction: **widely known vs well known**

widely known

emphasizes:

> known by many people / across many places.

well known

generally means:

> familiar to many people / famous.

They overlap strongly, but **widely** explicitly emphasizes breadth.

Important distinction: **widely accepted vs generally accepted**

widely accepted

= accepted across many people/groups.

generally accepted

= accepted in most cases/by most people.

Very close, but **widely** emphasizes spread.

Important distinction: **widely = broadly distributed vs widely = greatly different**

Compare:

> "She is **widely respected**."

= by many people.

versus:

> "Opinions **vary widely**."

= they differ greatly.

These are two genuinely useful adverb senses.

Important distinction: **wide range vs **large number****

**wide range of products**

= many different **types**.

**large number of products**

= many individual products.

A wide range emphasizes **variety**, not merely quantity.

Important distinction: **wide gap vs **big gap****

Both can mean:

> large difference.

**wide gap**

evokes distance/separation.

**big gap**

is more general and conversational.

Both are natural.

Important distinction: **wide of the mark vs **wrong****

wrong

= incorrect.

wide of the mark

= considerably inaccurate / far from the correct target.

It often emphasizes **how far** the estimate/statement misses reality.

Important distinction: **wide awake vs awake**

awake

= not sleeping.

wide awake

= completely awake, often with no sleepiness at all.

So **wide** functions as an intensifier here.

Important distinction: **widespread vs common**

common

= happens/exists frequently.

widespread

= exists across many people, places, or areas.

A phenomenon could be widespread geographically without being frequent at every location.

Important distinction: **widespread vs widely**

widespread

is adjective:

> widespread concern

widely

is adverb:

> widely respected

This is a key grammar contrast.

Important distinction: **widen vs broaden**

These overlap.

widen

often emphasizes increasing:

* physical width;

* gap;

* range.

broaden

often emphasizes increasing:

* knowledge;

* outlook;

* experience;

* scope.

Compare:

> widen the road

very natural.

> broaden your horizons

very natural.

> widen your horizons

also possible but less idiomatic than **broaden your horizons**.

Important distinction: **width** vs **breadth**

width

= measurable side-to-side distance.

breadth

can mean physical width but is also very common figuratively:

> breadth of knowledge

= 知識廣度.

So:

width is more concrete/measurable.

breadth is often more abstract.

Important distinction: **wide-ranging** vs **widespread**

wide-ranging

= covers many different subjects/areas.

> wide-ranging discussion

widespread

= exists in many places/among many people.

> widespread concern

Different type of breadth.

Family-extension sweep

The practical **wide** family is rich in physical breadth, range, distribution, difference, and degree:

* **wide — physical width** = 寬的
 * **wide road/table/river** = 寬闊的道路 / 桌 / 河
 * **wide open** = 大開 / 完全敞開
 * **open wide** = 張大 / 完全打開
 * **wide — broad range** = 廣泛的
 * **wide range** = 廣泛範圍 / 很多種類
 * **wide variety** = 多種多樣
 * **wide choice** = 選擇範圍廣
 * **wide gap/difference** = 很大的差距 / 差異
 * **widely — by many people/places** = 廣泛地 / 普遍地
 * **widely respected** = 廣受尊重
 * **widely known** = 廣為人知
 * **widely accepted** = 廣泛接受
 * **widely used** = 廣泛使用
 * **widely available** = 廣泛可得
 * **widely distributed** = 分布 / 派發廣泛
 * **vary widely** = 差異很大
 * **wide — miss target** = 偏離目標
 * **wide of the mark** = 偏離目標 / 判斷很不準
 * **far and wide** = 到處 / 四面八方
 * **wide awake** = 完全清醒
 * **wide-eyed** = 睜大眼 / 天真驚奇
 * **widespread** = 廣泛存在 / 普遍的
 * **widen — physical** = 拓寬 / 變寬
 * **widen a gap** = 擴大差距
 * **widen knowledge/experience** = 擴闊知識 / 經驗
 * **width** = 寬度
 * **wide-ranging** = 涵蓋範圍很廣
 * **widescreen** = 寬螢幕
 * **wide-angle** = 廣角

The main semantic branches are:

> **physical width**

> **broad range or variety**

> **large difference/gap**

> **spread across many people/places**

> **far from a target**

plus several common compounds and intensifying expressions.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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wide — physical width	從一邊到另一邊的橫向距離較大
wide open	門、眼睛、開口等張開到非常大的程度
wide — range	涵蓋的種類、範圍或領域很多 / 很廣
wide range	包含很多不同種類、程度或選項的範圍
wide variety	種類數量多而且彼此有所不同
wide choice	可供選擇的項目 / 種類很多
wide gap/difference	兩個數值、群體、觀點或狀態之間的差距很大
widely — broad distribution	在很多人、地方、群體或情況中都存在 / 發生
widely respected	受到很多人或不同群體普遍尊重
widely known	被很多人 / 很多地方的人知道
widely accepted	在很多人、群體或領域中獲得接受
widely used	在很多人、地方、領域或情況中使用
widely available	在很多地方 / 渠道都可以取得
widely — greatly	數值、看法、品質等彼此相差很大
vary widely	不同個案之間的程度 / 數值 / 意見差距很大
wide — miss target	從側面偏離目標，沒有擊中 / 到達目標
wide of the mark	實際或比喻上距離正確目標 / 答案很遠
far and wide	在很多地方、很大的地域範圍內；到處
wide awake	完全清醒、一點睡意也沒有
wide-eyed	眼睛睜大；亦可指天真、驚訝或充滿好奇
widespread	在很多地方 / 人群中廣泛存在或發生的
widen — physical	令某物的橫向寬度增加，或本身變寬
widen — figurative	令差距、分歧、範圍等進一步擴大
width	某物從一邊到另一邊的橫向距離
wide-ranging	涵蓋很多不同主題、領域或問題的
widescreen	畫面比例較寬的顯示 / 電影格式
wide-angle	能捕捉較廣視野範圍的鏡頭 / 攝影形式

For your original passage

> “She is ****widely respected**** in my family and even in the neighbourhood.”

The exact meaning is:

****widely = by many people / across a broad group****

Therefore:

> ****widely respected****

= ****「廣受尊重 / 受到很多人普遍尊重」****

The key idea is ****breadth****, not intensity.

That gives us an especially useful contrast:

> ****widely respected****

> = many people respect her

versus:

> ****highly respected****

> = people respect her very strongly / to a high degree

Your sentence emphasizes that her reputation for being:

* warm;

* patient;

* wise;

extends beyond just one close family member.

It reaches:

> the family

> → and even the neighbourhood.

That is why ****widely**** is such a natural choice.

The most important learner contrasts are:

> ****a wide road****

> = 寬闊的道路

> ****wide open****

> = 大開著

> ****a wide range of ideas****

> = 廣泛的想法 / 很多不同種類

> ****a wide variety****

> = 多種多樣

> ****a wide gap****

> = 很大的差距

> ****widely respected****

> = 廣受尊重

> ****widely known****

> = 廣為人知

> ****widely used****

> = 廣泛使用

> ****opinions vary widely****

> = 意見差異很大

> ****the shot went wide****

> = 射偏了

> ****wide of the mark****

> = 偏離目標 / 判斷不準

> ****far and wide****

> = 到處 / 四面八方

> ****wide awake****

> = 完全清醒

> ****widespread support****

> = 廣泛支持

> ****widen the gap****

> = 擴大差距

> ****width****

> = 寬度

> ****wide-ranging discussion****

> = 涵蓋範圍很廣的討論

So ****wide**** is far richer than simply:

> ****wide = 寬的****

and in your original passage its family form ****widely**** specifically means:

****“across many people and social circles — she is respected broadly throughout the family and neighbourhood.”****